08-09 第一篇

Desertification: A Growing Global Problem

Desertification is the process by which fertile land turns into desert. It happens when soil loses its ability to support plant life, often due to climate change, over farming, or poor water management. Millions of people around the world already face food shortages and forced migration because of this phenomenon. [1] The causes of desertification are complex, and reversing the damage requires both local action and international cooperation. Understanding these connections is the first step toward solutions.

One major cause of desertification is overgrazing by livestock. [2] When too many animals feed on the same land, they remove vegetation faster than it can grow back. Without plants to hold the soil, wind and rain easily wash or blow it away. In some regions, farmers have learned to rotate grazing areas or reduce herd sizes, allowing the land to recover. These practices show that change is possible with the right approach.

Deforestation also speeds up desertification. [3] Trees help keep soil in place and add moisture to the air through transpiration. When forests are cut down for farming or firewood, the land becomes exposed and dry. Reforestation projects in countries like China and Niger have proven that planting trees can slow or even reverse desertification in certain areas, though the work takes years or decades.

Water misuse is another key factor. [4] In many dry regions, people use groundwater faster than it can be replenished. Wells run dry, and crops fail. Drip irrigation, rainwater harvesting, and better crop choices can reduce water waste and help land stay productive. Governments and NGOs are sharing these techniques with communities that need them most.

[5] Desertification is not inevitable. With sustainable farming, forest protection, and smart water use, we can restore degraded land and protect the livelihoods of millions. The fight against desertification is a fight for food security and peace in some of the world's most vulnerable regions.

选项

A. Solving it demands a clear view of cause and effect. B. Too many animals on limited land leads to soil destruction. C. Restoring tree cover can bring land back to life. D. Better water practices can turn the tide in dry areas. E. Hope lies in combining knowledge with action. F. For example, the Sahel region in Africa has seen both severe drought and successful green belts.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍荒漠化的定义、成因及对人口的影响，空后强调成因复杂、需本地行动与国际合作。A项"解决它需要清楚认识因果"承上（complex causes）启下（understanding→solutions），概括衔接。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：本段主题为过度放牧，写牲畜过多啃食、植被无法恢复、土壤流失。B项"过多动物在有限土地上导致土壤破坏"与overgrazing、remove vegetation、soil washes away逻辑一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：段中写森林固土、增加湿度，砍伐后土地裸露干旱，并举中国、尼日尔造林为例。C项"恢复植被覆盖能使土地重焕生机"概括本段内容。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：段首点明水资源滥用，后文提及地下水超采、滴灌、雨水收集、作物选择。D项"更好的用水实践能在干旱地区扭转局面"与段意相符。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：结尾段以[5]开头，后文总结可持续农业、森林保护、智慧用水可恢复土地、保障生计。E项"希望在于将知识与行动结合"总领全段，呼应sustainable farming等具体行动。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example...**：以For example开头，虽与荒漠化、萨赫勒相关，但仅为区域案例，与任一段落的概括或承启功能不符，论述层次偏低。